



Proposal Writing, MBI F602

1 Credit
Fall, 2024

Land Acknowledgement

- The University of Alaska Fairbanks' (UAF) Troth Yeddha' campus in Fairbanks, Alaska is located on the unceded, traditional homelands of the Lower Tanana Dene.
- UAF's College of Fisheries and Ocean Sciences campus in Juneau, Alaska is located on the unceded territories of the Áak'w K'wáan.
- A map of Indigenous Peoples and Languages of Alaska can be found [here](#).

COVID-19 statement

Students should keep up-to-date on the university's policies, practices, and mandates related to COVID-19 by regularly checking [this website](#). Students are expected to adhere to the university's policies, practices, and mandates related to public health. While the formal COVID-19 response has ended, the advice that was true throughout the pandemic remains true now - please stay home if you are sick, cover your cough, and wash your hands to help keep our university communities healthy.

General Information

<i>Instructor:</i>	Kristen Gorman	<i>Office Location:</i>	Irving II, room 231
<i>Email:</i>	kbgorman@alaska.edu	<i>Office Hours:</i>	Tuesdays 10–11 am, anytime by appointment.
<i>Telephone:</i>	907-474-5930	<i>*Course Type:</i>	Lecture: In-person, Online, Synchronous
<i>**Course Location:</i>	In-person: O'Neill, room 214 Online: https://alaska.zoom.us/join/8pG9dsZznrP7E6KYxPCq6Pc6p Canvas is our Learning Management System.	<i>Meeting Time:</i>	Tuesdays 8:00–9:30 am Thursdays 8:00–9:30 am (Aug 26, 2024 - Dec 14, 2024)* Final: None *We will not meet each week this semester, see detailed schedule below.

Additional General Information

- As this course's instructor, I respectfully acknowledge Alaska's First Peoples and their long history of living in deep connection with their land and water, and the historical and ongoing legacy of colonialism. As a life-long student, I am committed to learning about injustice, and working to improve equity in my professional and personal life.



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- This course meets in-person and online via Zoom during lecture hours (i.e., synchronously, see details above). **All students** (i.e., in-person or online attendees) **must register in advance** for the Zoom meeting to allow for the possibility of meeting entirely remotely due to unforeseen circumstances. After registering, you will receive a confirmation email containing information about joining the meeting, **you can save this information to your Google calendar to easily find the Zoom link each week.**
- Our in-class sessions will be recorded via Zoom to provide flexibility to those students who cannot attend. These recordings will be posted on Canvas (see weekly Modules), and therefore only available to enrolled students in this class. Despite classes being recorded, **students who will miss class should notify the instructor in advance** (see details below).
- If you need assistance navigating Zoom or Canvas please contact your instructor or [UAF's eCampus Student Support](#).

Prerequisites and Proficiencies

None, graduate standing.

Course description

Familiarize students with the proposal writing process. Writing proposals is a common requirement during graduate school and will be continuing during one's career as a scientist and researcher. This class aims to cover some common rules about good proposal writing.

In-depth Course description

The purpose of this class is to familiarize students in STEM with the proposal writing process. Writing proposals is a common requirement during graduate school and is something that will continue during one's career as a researcher. Writing a good proposal takes a lot of practice, and this class aims to cover some common rules about good proposal writing. The class will cover the different parts of a typical proposal, and we will discuss good practices and common mistakes. Students will write their own research proposal in class, and they will receive reviews on the proposal from the instructor and their classmates. They will also each review proposals of their classmates and provide constructive, critical oral and written feedback.

The course schedule (see below) will allow students to have sections of time in between in-person class meetings to work on their proposals to implement the learned material and to review fellow student proposals.

Course Readings

Required text: None

Additional required readings: Various materials for each class will be made available on [Canvas](#), see weekly Modules for specifics.



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Technology Requirements

The course requires regular access to a computer and the internet to view and download any online materials on [Canvas](#), or electronic resources. At various points during the semester, you will need to download course material and provide feedback to your classmates. For the purposes of this course, **please use your @alaska.edu email account only for correspondence with the instructor**, or the Canvas inbox feature to ensure that you do not miss any important information from the instructor.

Course Goals

- Develop a good understanding of the various parts and their interconnectivity of a scientific proposal
- Write a proposal that addresses required proposal sections
- Understand how to critically review a scientific proposal

Student Learning Outcomes

- The expected outcome is that students will have a good grasp of what it takes to write a strong proposal, and they will learn what makes a proposal successful. Students will gain experience in proposal writing and in reviewing proposals critically.

Instructional Methods

The course is lecture- and peer-review-based. Students are expected to attend class during regular meeting times, review reading materials as communicated by the instructor, and required to contribute to class discussions and peer-review of proposals. Students who must attend remotely will be able to do so via Zoom during meeting times. Lecture slides will be made available after class and lectures will be recorded for students with excused absences or those attending asynchronously. Lecture slides and recordings will be made available on [Canvas](#), see weekly Modules.

Assignments: There are **four** assignments for the class:

1. Formulate the hypotheses for the proposal you intend to write and those will be discussed in class. This provides you with the central piece of your proposal around which you can then assemble all other pieces of the proposal.
2. Develop a brief outline of your introduction and methods and those will be discussed in class. This should set you up for the next step of writing a full proposal.
3. Write a full proposal. The format of the proposal to be written can be chosen freely but has to be announced to the class and the chosen format followed. The proposal topic can/should be that of the graduate research but cannot be copied from a proposal that has been used by the advisor to obtain funding for the work; i.e., you have to make this your very own proposal. There will be two rounds of proposal review.
4. Review proposals of your classmates (two reviews per round) and provide critical and constructive comments during in-class discussions. We are planning on having two rounds of proposal reviews.

See [Canvas](#) weekly Modules for readings and any specific details regarding associated proposal reviews or approaches to proposal writing.

Explanation of Student Effort

Students are expected to attend ~1.5 hours of lecture/discussion each scheduled class period, and spend another 1 hour per lecture each week preparing assignments and reviews. In general, students should expect to spend about 4-5 hours each week on this course.



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Note: this is a 1 credit course, and as such participants would typically meet for 1 hour each week during the semester. There are several weeks during the semester this course does not meet during which time you should be working on your proposal, proposal revisions, and proposal reviews. Thus, our total class meeting time will be about 15-20 hours over the entire semester, which is similar to other 1 credit courses that meet 1 hour each week.

Tentative Course Calendar

Note: Assignments can be due on dates where there is no in-person meeting, so please pay attention to the dates.

Week	Date	Topic	Readings	Assignments	Delivery
1	Tues, Aug 27	Course Intro and Syllabus	None	None	In person & Zoom
1	Thurs, Aug 29	Requests for Proposals	RFP examples	None	In person & Zoom
2	Tues, Sept 3	Proposal hypotheses	TBD	Work on hypotheses	In person & Zoom
2	Thurs, Sept 5	Proposal methods	TBD	Work on hypotheses and methods	In person & Zoom
2	Fri, Sept 6	<i>Last day to add class or drop with refund</i>	-----		
3	Tues, Sept 10	Proposal introductions <i>No class, Gorman in field</i>	TBD	Discuss hypotheses and methods	Asynchronous
3	Thurs, Sept 12	<i>No class, Gorman in field</i>	None	Due @ 5 pm - Hypotheses	None
4	Tues, Sept 17	<i>No class, Gorman at AFS</i>	None	<i>Work on proposal outlines</i>	None
4	Thurs, Sept 19	<i>No class, Gorman at AFS</i>	None	<i>Work on proposal outlines</i>	None
5	Tues, Sept 24	Student discussion – outlines	None	Discuss outlines	In person & Zoom
5	Thurs, Sept 26	Abstracts	TBD	Due @ 5 pm – Intro and Methods Outline	In person & Zoom



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6	Tues, Oct 1	Good writing practice	TBD	None	In person & Zoom
6	Thurs, Oct 3	Budgets	TBD	None	In person & Zoom
7	Mon, Oct 7	Mid-term grades due	-----		
7	Tues, Oct 8	No class	Proposal examples	Work on proposals, round 1	
7	Thurs, Oct 10	No class	Proposal examples	Work on proposals, round 1	
8	Tues, Oct 15	No class	None	Work on proposals, round 1	
8	Thurs, Oct 17	No class	None	Due @ 5 pm - Proposals Round 1	
9	Tues, Oct 22	Proposal 1 reviews	None	Work on proposal round 1 reviews	
9	Thurs, Oct 24	Proposal 1 reviews	None	Present proposal round 1 reviews	
10	Tues, Oct 29	No class	None	Work on proposal round 2 revisions	
10	Thurs, Oct 31	No class	None	Work on proposal round 2 revisions	
10	Fri, Nov 1	Deadline for student- and faculty-initiated withdrawals (W on transcript)	-----		
11	Tues, Nov 5	No class	None	Work on proposal round 2 revisions	
11	Thurs, Nov 7	No class	None	Work on proposal round 2 revisions	



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12	Tues, Nov 12	Proposal 2 reviews	None	Work on proposal round 2 reviews	
12	Thurs, Nov 14	Proposal 2 reviews	None	Present proposal round 2 reviews	
13	Tues, Nov 19	No class, Gorman off campus		Work on proposal round 2 revisions after review	
13	Thurs, Nov 21	No class, Gorman off campus		Work on proposal round 2 revisions after review	
14	Tues, Nov 26	Instructor proposal feedback	None		
14	Thurs, Nov 28	No class, UAF Fall Break			
15	Tues, Dec 3	Instructor proposal feedback	None		
15	Thurs, Dec 5	No class		Due @ 5 pm – Proposals Round 2	
15	Fri, Dec 6	Last day of instruction			
16	Fri Dec 9-14	Finals week – No Final!			

Assignment Submission

Please submit your files as:

- Hypotheses: last name_first initial_hypo
- Outline of introduction and methods: last name_first initial_out
- Proposal 1: last name_first initial_prop1
- Proposal 2: last name_first initial_prop2

For all reviews you do, please add your initials after an underscore at the end of the existing filename. For example, my edited file versions will have _KG at the end of the file name.

Evaluation

- This is a pass/fail class. To get a pass, all class meetings have to be attended unless otherwise arranged with the instructor. All assignments (hypotheses, outlines, proposal, reviews) have to be submitted by the given deadlines.

Regular and Substantive Interaction (RSI)

To be compliant with federal law and Northwest Commission on Colleges and Universities (NWCCU) accreditation requirements, UAF faculty must ensure that all courses where faculty and students are not



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physically located in the same space for which students use federal financial aid have regular and substantive interaction (RSI) between students and instructors. Regular refers to interactions that are scheduled and predictable. Substantive refers to engaging students in teaching, learning, and assessment, consistent with course content.

As your faculty member, I have included the following actions in this course to meet RSI requirements:

- Providing direct instruction
- Providing feedback on student's coursework
- Providing course-related information or answering questions
- Facilitating group discussions about content or competencies

An RSI Student Survey will be required of all students enrolled in this course that regularly attend via Zoom and will be administered via Canvas within four weeks of the beginning of the course.

Course Policies

1.) Expectations On Progress In Coursework

- The objective is to enhance your learning by interaction with other students who have different ideas and contributions than you do. Thus, you have an obligation to not only learn from them, but to participate and help them learn from you.
- All assignments submitted are to be entirely your own work, unless you receive specific instructions to the contrary. I expect high ethical standards and cheating, plagiarism, or other forms of academic dishonesty are unacceptable. Honesty is crucial to establishing oneself as a credible scientist and professional. Adherence to the [UAF Student Code of Conduct](#) is mandatory.
- Graduate students are welcome to use Artificial Intelligence (AI) resources to help research their ideas, however, students should use their own writing and communicating of their own work. If any portion of a student's work is derived from AI resources, these must be cited appropriately. Student written work will be vetted through AI detection software, any use of AI that not properly cited will be subject to Academic Honesty violations.
- Please make sure you use your current @alaska.edu email address for all course correspondence. Check your e-mail messages regularly. Class information and changes to the syllabus will be distributed through Canvas to your email. Please note that the course schedule is "tentative", and the "actual" course schedule will be a living document that evolves over the semester (see Canvas).
- This course will require students to have access to the internet, a personal computer, and familiarity with basic computer software programs such as Word, PowerPoint, and Excel.

2.) Attendance, Tardiness, Class Participation, Make-up Exams

- Attendance is required for the course, either in-person or via Zoom, during the course meeting times. Students can miss one class unexcused, but reviewing the material covered during the missed class is your responsibility.
- Students are expected to participate in all aspects of the course including during lectures by asking questions, and during peer-to-peer discussion session. Please come to class ready to engage with the course material, your fellow classmates, and the instructor.



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- Regular attendance, consistent participation, and timely submission of assignments are important for building professional skills and abilities, this course seeks to develop and reinforce such etiquette. Late submission of assignments can result in a fail grade.
- If you have a schedule conflict with class attendance, e.g., attending a meeting, going to sea, please inform me in advance. You are responsible for any material that is covered in your absence, i.e., readings and lectures. Powerpoint slides and the lecture recording will be available after class and posted on Canvas in weekly modules.

3.) Plagiarism & Academic Integrity

Academic dishonesty applies to examinations, assignments, laboratory reports, fieldwork, practicums, creative projects, or other academic activities. Examples include, but are not limited to:

- a) presenting as their own the ideas or works of others without proper citation of sources;
- b) utilizing devices not authorized by the faculty member;
- c) using sources (including but not limited to text, images, computer code, and audio/video files) not authorized by the faculty member;
- d) providing assistance without the faculty member's permission to another student, or receiving assistance not authorized by the faculty member from anyone (with or without their knowledge);
- e) submitting work done for academic credit in previous classes, without the knowledge and advance permission of the current faculty member;
- f) acting as a substitute or utilizing a substitute;
- g) deceiving faculty members or other representatives of the university to affect a grade or to gain admission to a program or course;
- h) fabricating or misrepresenting data;
- i) possessing, buying, selling, obtaining, or using a copy of any material intended to be used as an instrument of assessment in advance of its administration;
- j) altering grade records of their own or another student's work;
- k) offering a monetary payment or other remuneration in exchange for a grade; or
- l) violating the ethical guidelines or professional standards of a given program.

For more, see [Students Rights and Responsibilities](#).

Plagiarism is scientifically unethical and will not be tolerated in any way during this class.

4.) Classroom Etiquette and Student Behavior Guidelines.

- As with all members of the UAF community, the university requires all in-person and online students to conduct themselves honestly and responsibly and to respect the rights of others. Students may not engage in behavior that disrupts the learning environment, violates the rights of others, or otherwise violates the student code of conduct, university rules, regulations, or procedures. More information about the UAF Student Code of Conduct and Student Rights and Responsibilities can be found [here](#).
- High ethical standards are expected of all students in this course. Violations of the UAF Student Code of Conduct will result in an immediate "F" grade. Additionally, violations of the Student Code of Conduct may result in disciplinary action initiated by UAF.
- No cell phone use is allowed during class.
- Note that this class will meet in person and delivered remotely via zoom. Please arrive in person or connect early so we can start the class on time.

5.) Extended Absence Policy

Extended absences are defined as missed classes or course work by students beyond what is permissible by the instructor's written course policies. Students may need to miss class and/or course work for a variety of reasons, including, but not limited to:



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- bereavement
- personal illness or injury
- serious illness of a friend, family member or loved one
- military obligations
- jury service
- other emergency or obligatory situations

For more information, go to the student handbook or the Center for Students Rights and Responsibilities.

6.) UAF Incomplete Grade Policy:

Your instructor follows the University of Alaska Fairbanks Incomplete Grade Policy:

"The letter 'I' (Incomplete) is a temporary grade used to indicate that the student has satisfactorily completed (C- or better) the majority of work in a course but for personal reasons beyond the student's control, such as sickness, has not been able to complete the course during the regular semester. Negligence or indifference are not acceptable reasons for an 'I' grade."

For more information, see [the UAF regulations regarding grades](#).

Student Protections Statement

UAF embraces and grows a culture of respect, diversity, inclusion, and caring. Students at this university are protected against sexual harassment and discrimination (Title IX). Faculty members are designated as responsible employees which means they are required to report sexual misconduct. Graduate teaching assistants do not share the same reporting obligations. For more information on your rights as a student and the resources available to you to resolve problems, please go to the following site: <https://catalog.uaf.edu/academics-regulations/students-rights-responsibilities/>.

Disabilities Services Statement

I will work with the Office of Disability Services to provide reasonable accommodation to students with disabilities.

ASUAF Advocacy Statement

The Associated Students of the University of Alaska Fairbanks, the student government of UAF, offers advocacy services to students who feel they are facing issues with staff, faculty, and/or other students specifically if these issues are hindering the ability of the student to succeed in their academics or go about their lives at the university. Students who wish to utilize these services can contact the Student Advocacy Director by visiting the ASUAF office or emailing asuaf.office@alaska.edu.

Non-Discrimination Statement

The University of Alaska is an affirmative action/equal opportunity employer and educational institution. The University of Alaska does not discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, national origin, citizenship, age, sex, physical or mental disability, status as a protected veteran, marital status, changes in marital status, pregnancy, childbirth or related medical conditions, parenthood, sexual orientation, gender identity, political affiliation or belief, genetic information, or other legally protected status. The University's commitment to nondiscrimination, including against sex discrimination, applies to students, employees, and applicants for admission and employment. Contact information, applicable laws, and complaint procedures are included on UA's statement of nondiscrimination available at www.alaska.edu/nondiscrimination. For more information, contact:



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UAF Office of Rights, Compliance and Accountability
1692 Tok Lane, 3rd floor, Constitution Hall, Fairbanks, AK 99775
907-474-7300
uaf-orca@alaska.edu

Student Academic Support

- Communication Center (907-474-7007, uaf-commcenter@alaska.edu, Student Success Center, 6th Floor Room 677 Rasmussen Library)
- Writing Center (907-474-5314, uaf-writing-center@alaska.edu, Student Success Center, 6th Floor Room 677 Rasmussen Library)
- UAF Math Services (907-474-7332, uaf-traccloud@alaska.edu)

Drop-in tutoring, Student Success Center, 6th Floor Room 677 Rasmussen Library)
1:1 tutoring (by appointment only), Chapman 210

Online tutoring (by appointment only) available

<https://www.uaf.edu/dms/mathlab/>, available at the Student Success Center

- Developmental Math Lab (Gruening 406, <https://www.uaf.edu/deved/math/>)
- The Debbie Moses Learning Center at CTC (907-455-2860, 604 Barnette St, Room 120, <https://www.ctc.uaf.edu/student-services/student-success-center/>)
- For more information and resources, please see the Academic Advising Resource List <https://www.uaf.edu/advising/students/index.php>

Other Student Resources:

- Disability Services (907-474-5655, uaf-disability-services@alaska.edu, 110 Eielson Building)
- Student Health & Counseling [**free counseling sessions available**] (907-474-7043, <https://www.uaf.edu/chc/appointments.php>, Whitaker Building 2nd floor)
- Office of Rights, Compliance and Accountability (907-474-7300, uaf-orca@alaska.edu, 3rd Floor, Constitution Hall)
- Associated Students of the University of Alaska Fairbanks (ASUAF) or ASUAF Student Government (907-474-7355, asuaf.office@alaska.edu, Wood Center 119)

Title IX

University of Alaska Board of Regents have clearly stated in BOR Policy that discrimination, harassment and violence will not be tolerated on any campus of the University of Alaska. If you believe you are experiencing discrimination or any form of harassment including sexual harassment/misconduct/assault, you are encouraged to report that behavior. If you report to a faculty member or any university employee, they must notify the UAF Title IX Coordinator about the basic facts of the incident.

Your choices for reporting include:



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1. You may access confidential counseling by contacting the UAF Health & Counseling Center at 907-474-7043;
2. You may access support and file a Title IX report by contacting the UAF Title IX Coordinator at 907-474-6600;
3. You may file a criminal complaint by contacting the University Police Department at 907-474-7721. For more information please visit the [UAF Department of Equity and Compliance](#) webpage.

Any UAF employee or volunteer who reasonably suspects or observes minor abuse or maltreatment is required to report the incident. Reporting procedures are available on the UAF Protection of Minors. Violation of this policy by employees shall be reported as well.

Emergency Notification Plan

Students will receive emergency notifications via phone or email. Please check your uaonline account to confirm your emergency notification settings. for more information, please refer to the student handbook. In cases where you do not have access to your devices, as your instructor, I will take responsibility to relay any emergency notifications.